EDI Challenge 2026 — Overview & Instructions

A creative, hands-on mini-project to explore how you think, learn, research, and build.

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1. What This Challenge Is — and Why We Do It

The EDI Challenge is a *quick, fun, and fully hands-on* exercise that introduces you to a simple blockchain use case: creating a small online application that can mint a "thank-you card," a "farewell card," or a playful "completion badge" using NFTs on a test network.

It's **not an exam**, and it's **not about perfection**.
It's about creativity, resourcefulness, and your ability to explore unfamiliar topics with curiosity. We want to see how you approach problems, how you learn, and how you build — not how flawless the result is.

This challenge should be enjoyable, lightweight, and achievable for anyone willing to dive in and experiment, while also allowing you to be creative and challenge yourself to go as far as you can!

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2. The Spirit of the Challenge

- **No cost:** Everything must be built using free, publicly available tools.
- **AI expected:** You are warmly encouraged — in fact, expected — to use AI tools (ChatGPT, Claude, Copilot, etc.) to research, design, troubleshoot, and build your solution.
- **Online and simple:** Your small app should be publicly accessible and deployed on **Polygon Testnet**.
- **Open and accessible:** The application must be publicly accessible to anyone, without login or wallet connection. Any user should be able to create a badge and send it to **any wallet address** they choose.
- **Creative freedom:** The design, structure, and style of the badge and the app are entirely up to you.
- **Learn as you go:** Use online tutorials, boilerplates, examples, AI prompts, or anything that helps you progress.

There is **no penalty** if you don't finish every feature. Just do your best within the time available.

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3. Challenge Information (to be filled by EDI)

Candidate name: **Antoine Huertier**
Date started: **Friday March 27th**
Submission deadline: **Tuesday March 31st at 2359 CET**

Polygon address of examiner for receiving the badge:

0x0c4869fd5A92ed96Aef6EFAeFCfdC1BEe931B67F

EDI Challenge interview

Colleague who will follow up to schedule: TBC
Examiner's Email, Title: rafa.jimenez@elca.ch **/ VP of ELCA Digital Innovation**
Potential date of EDI Challenge interview: anytime in the 2 workday weeks after the submission deadline

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4. What You Need to Deliver

By the deadline above, you should submit to examiner's email **one of the following**:

Option A (ideal): You completed the core flow

You have minted the badge on Polygon Testnet (you get to decide what kind of image you add to the NFT) and **successfully sent it to the examiner's wallet**.

Please submit:

- The **public URL** of your small application
- The **smart contract address**
- The **token ID** of the badge you minted
- **Your** Polygon wallet address (so we can send you a badge back)
- A link to your GitHub or similar repo (any public code repository)

Option B: You didn't finish the full flow (totally acceptable!)

If you ran out of time or couldn't get everything working end-to-end, simply submit:

- Your code as it stands
- A short explanation of what you built so far
- Any screenshots or working components
- Notes about what you attempted, where you got stuck, what you would try next

The goal is to learn *how* you approached the challenge — not to judge you on completion.

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5. What We Will Look At (Not "Evaluate")

In the interview, we will not talk about right or wrong. Instead, we will explore:

- **Your research path:** How you learned what you needed
- **Your technical decisions:** Why you chose certain tools or frameworks
- **Your challenges:** What didn't work, and how you approached solving it
- **Your creativity:** How you designed the badge, the UI, or the flow
- **Your problem-solving approach:** Not the result — the reasoning
- **Your resourcefulness:** How you used free tools, AI, documentation, etc.

This is a conversation, not a test.

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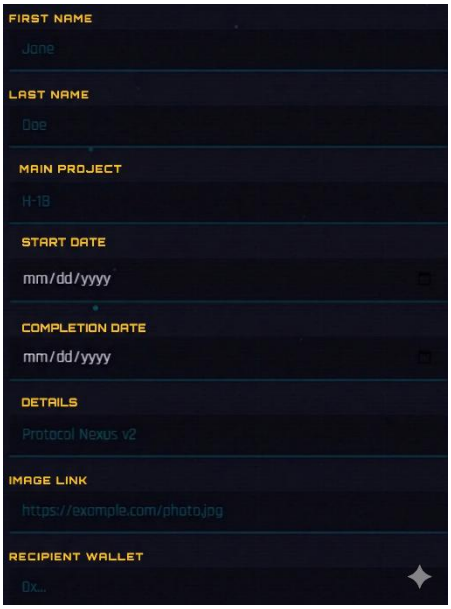
6. Your Application — What It Should Ideally Do

(Again, if not all steps work — no problem. This is just the target.)



1. **A small online form** where the user can enter the following information
    - First Name | Last Name
    - Main Project
    - Start date (manual entry and/or calendar selector)
    - Completion Date,
    - Details
    - Image Link
    - Recipient Wallet
2. **A live preview** of the badge (what it will look like after minting), updated in real-time as the data is entered.
3. **Minting a badge** on Polygon Testnet (NFT)
4. **Sending the badge** to any recipient wallet address provided by the user
5. **Simple transaction feedback** (success message or block explorer link)

Technical Constraints

These are the only hard constraints:

- The NFT must follow the ERC-721 standard.
- The smart contract must be deployed on the Polygon Amoy Testnet.
- The badge must have a visual representation (image) that is generated from the input data, not a static file.
- The person using the application **does not need to connect a wallet or own testnet POL.** They should be able to create and mint a badge as a public user. Only the recipient of the NFT needs a wallet address.

The app must be a web application, hosted **and publicly accessible**, without having to log-in, create an account or pay to access it
Your badge does not need to be perfect — just functional and generated from the input.

Free hosting options you may consider include: GitHub Pages, Vercel, Fleek, etc.

In simple terms: this is a public badge generator — not a personal wallet-based dApp.

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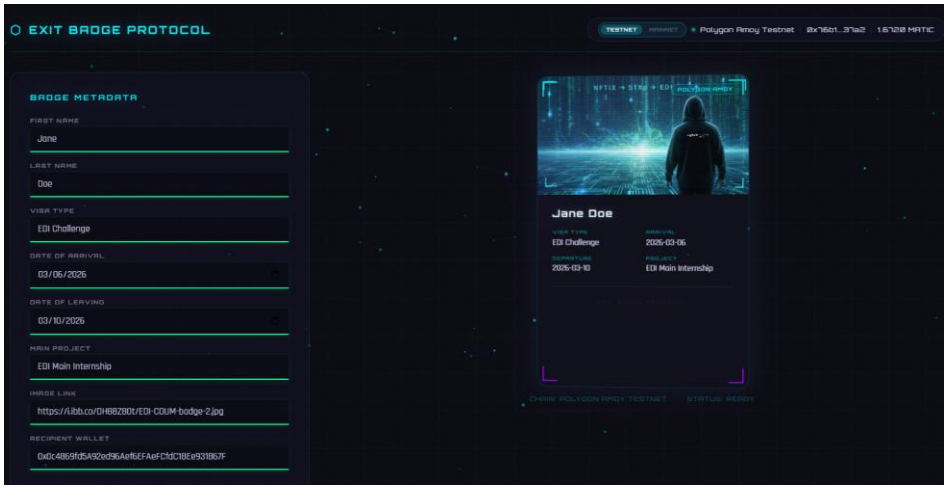
7. Support Material Provided

You will find:

- SEE HERE **short explainer video** showing an example flow
- This **screenshot** below shows an example of a previous tool created, NOTE that this is just for illustration, (e.g., the input fields are different than the specific instructions you received in point 6. This is NOT a template, you can follow any structure or style you wish, **creativity is encouraged**!
- 

8. After You Submit

Once you submit your work (complete or partial) by email to the examiner by the provided deadline above, you will have the EDI Interview. Ideally within the next 10 workdays. **Elena Ristic or the examiner** will reach out to you to schedule the follow-up interview.

The entire interview will focus on your **process**, not your "success":

- What did you learn?
- What did you try?
- What surprised you?
- What would you improve with more time?
- How did you use AI?
- How did you troubleshoot problems?

There is no failing this challenge — only learning.

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9. Bonus Examples

You are welcome to go above and beyond what is being asked here.
Here's one example of a bonus feature:

- **Mainnet deployment:** Deploy your smart contract on Polygon Mainnet as well and add a network switch in your UI that allows the user to toggle between Testnet and Mainnet. The app should handle both networks seamlessly, same experience, different chain. (contact: Rafa Jimenez if you require **a small amount of POL tokens for gas fees**.
- **Image upload:** you may decide to ensure that the end user can upload any image size (& aspect ratio) they have, and manage the functions of autoscaling, cropping etc, on the dApp-side to always show the image without distortion

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10. Closing Note

The EDI Challenge is meant to be enjoyable, exploratory, and creative.
There is no pressure to finish everything flawlessly.
What matters is how you think, how you learn, and how you build.

Have fun — and don't hesitate to use AI heavily throughout the process.
We're looking forward to seeing what you create.